a bud or flower appeared; but the ashes all flew into the prince's eyes and mouth, blinding and choking him. When the prince's retainers saw this, they seized the old man, and beat him almost to death, so that he crawled off home in a very sorry plight. When he and his wife found out what a trap they had fallen into, they scolded themselves.

The good old man and woman, as soon as they heard of their neighbours' distress, sent for them, and, after reproving them for their greed and cruelty, gave them a share of their own riches, which, by repeated strokes of luck, had now increased to a goodly sum. So, the wicked old people mended their ways, and led good and virtuous lives ever after.

Glossary

tit-bit (n):

a small piece of tasty food

wagging (n):

moving or causing to move rapidly to and fro

covetous (adj):

having or showing a great desire to possess something belonging to someone else

obliged (v):

make (someone) legally or morally bound to do something

mortar (n):

a hard, strong bound in which substances are crushed to powder

withered (v):

become dry and shriveled

A. Identify the character or speaker of the following lines.

1. They gathered the treasure.
2. The pine tree under which I am buried, to be cut down and made into a mortar.
3. They dug, and found nothing but a quantity of dirt and nasty offal.
4. He had not to wait long before he was called into the prince's palace, and ordered to exhibit his power.
5. BOW, WOW, WOW!

B. Based on your understanding of the story, choose the right answers from the given options.

1. The old farmer and his wife loved the dog
   a) because it helped them in their day-to-day work.
   b) as if it was their own baby.
   c) as they were kind to all living beings.

2. When the old couple became rich, they
   a) gave the dog better food.
   b) invited their greedy neighbours to a feast.
   c) lived a comfortable life and were generous towards their poor neighbours.

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